

Kenji Hilasaca

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 github.com/kenji.hilasak  [Portfolio: kenjihilasak.github.io](https://kenjihilasak.github.io)

Data and AI Engineer with 6+ years of experience designing scalable data platforms, machine-learning solutions and automated workflows across financial services, consulting and academic research. Experienced in Python, SQL, PySpark, AWS, NLP and production integration, with a strong focus on data quality, lineage, reusable architectures and translating complex processes into controlled workflows. MSc Data Science (Distinction); UK Graduate Visa valid until March 2028.

CORE SKILLS

- **Agentic AI:** LangGraph, RAG, structured LLM outputs, tool-based workflows, human-in-the-loop design, semantic research. Selected project: Luke-Bot – Agentic AI Community Data Platform (Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, OpenAI API).
- **Data Engineering:** SQL, PySpark, Hadoop, ETL, data modelling, data marts, Airflow, REST APIs.
- **Machine Learning:** Scikit-learn, XGBoost, TensorFlow, Hugging Face Transformers, MLFlow.
- **Cloud & Governance:** AWS Glue, S3, Step Functions, EC2, Azure, Docker, Git, Linux, data quality lineage, validation, monitoring and auditability.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

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- Research Assistant** | University of Leeds - *NLP & Data Science* January 2026 - Present
- Architected reusable multilingual NLP workflows on an enterprise Linux cluster equipped with NVIDIA GPUs, reducing processing time by 87% (from 48 hours down to 6 hours).
 - Co-authored and presented peer-reviewed research at the LREC-BUCC workshop on text-alignment and parallel corpora extraction for automated text simplification tasks.
 - Built extraction, transformation, and validation pipelines for semi-structured text, embedding data-quality, lineage, and integrity controls for the iDem project (EU-funded, €1M+ budget).
- Data Engineer** | BBVA - *Corporate & Investment Banking* March 2024 - September 2024
- Designed and deployed distributed data pipelines (PySpark, Hadoop, AWS Step Functions) reducing data processing latency by 50%.
 - Developed XGBoost client-classification model and operationalised its outputs through DAG-based orchestration to automate end-to-end ML pipeline execution within corporate banking applications to personalise corporate lending strategies and increase retention.
 - Delivered reliable data and ML solutions using sensitive financial information within production environments, ensuring compliance with stakeholder and business requirements.
- Data Base Analyst** | INDRA - *Telecoms Consulting* October 2022 - February 2024
- Developed predictive models for late payments and frauds (Scikit-learn, XGBoost), driving \$20M annual cash flow improvement.
 - Designed feature engineering pipelines and automated ETL (Python, SQL) ensuring traceable, high-quality data flows.
 - Communicated model insights and KPIs to senior finance and operations teams through interactive dashboards.
- Software Engineer** | PLAYTEC - *Software Development* January 2016 - October 2020
- Designed and integrated REST APIs connecting internal applications, SQL databases and machine-learning services, enabling reliable data exchange and automated business workflows.
 - Containerised services with Docker and contributed to cloud and CI/CD deployment workflows, improving system performance, maintainability and release consistency.

EDUCATION

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- University of Leeds** | United Kingdom September 2024 - September 2025
MSc in Data Science and Analytics | Distinction
- Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT IDSS)** | Remote May 2022 - October 2023
MITx Micromaster in Statistics and Data Science
- National University of Engineering (UNI)** | Peru March 2010 - July 2016
BSc Mechatronic Engineering | GPA 3.5/4.0 (2:1 UK equivalent)